Aashi Thakkar

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Summary

Engineer-first product and AI strategist who ships. Builds AI products people use daily: a multi-agent platform serving 8,000+ users, plus personal apps for recommendation and discovery (Blind Spot, Vibe Route). Runs experiments that move real usage, and designs for personalization and user trust. Featured in NVIDIA's customer story; presented at the Databricks Data + AI Summit.

Experience

RBC Capital Markets **Jan 2025 – Present**

Senior Product Manager - Alternative Data, GenAI & Research Technology *Toronto, ON*

- Shipped 7 AI agents to production as strategy and roadmap owner for **AidenResearch**, a flagship GenAI platform used daily across an 8,000-user base.
- Grew adoption 25% by running 8+ experiments and A/B tests, then shipping the changes that moved real usage.
- Built personalization that matched AI-generated drafts to each user's voice and style, so first drafts needed less editing before publish.
- Launched natural-language search across the platform, cutting time-to-answer from hours to seconds.
- Set the quality bar for user-facing AI, holding agents to a 99% accuracy bar (99.7% in production) and cutting hallucinated outputs from 15% to 4% with the evaluation and guardrails users could trust.
- Drove the roadmap across 4–5 AI products, breaking a 2-month senior-leadership prioritization deadlock that greenlit a new flagship product now central to expanding coverage.
- Led a 20-person cross-functional team across engineering, data science, and design to ship AI products users rely on.

RBC Capital Markets **Sept 2023 – Dec 2024**

Software Developer *Toronto, ON*

- Lifted feature adoption 45% with a reusable React/Next.js/MUI component library, built into a real-time trading and reporting platform.
- Boosted platform performance 40% with React Query caching and API optimization, plus a charting and tooltip design that helped users read complex data faster (comprehension +25%).

Cognizant Technology Solutions **Mar 2021 – June 2022**

Programmer Analyst *Pune, India*

- Resolved 200+ client issues and 150+ production defects on a 50-person team, building SQL pipelines and full-stack applications across the SDLC.

Projects

Blind Spot | GitHub | Live

- **80% of what you watch was chosen by an algorithm; this shows you what it's hiding.** Surfaces your Netflix filter bubble with content-based profiling, cosine similarity, and a Herfindahl diversity index, then uses an LLM (constrained to verified data to prevent hallucination) to recommend titles you'd never have found.

Vibe Route | GitHub | Live

- **Google Maps tells you the fastest route; this tells you the best one.** An AI walking-route scorer that ranks streets by how they *feel* using density-based clustering and LLM-generated narratives; rejected LLM-based scoring to avoid the affluence bias that keeps Maps from shipping this, grounding the design in 6 peer-reviewed studies.

Technical Skills

AI/ML: GenAI, LLMs, AI Agents, Recommendation Systems, Personalization, RAG, Prompt Engineering, Model Evaluation & Guardrails, Responsible AI
Product: Product Strategy, Roadmapping, 0-to-1 / Innovation, Experimentation / A-B Testing, User Research, Adoption & Activation, Prioritization & Trade-offs, Go-to-Market
Delivery & Analysis: Product Owner, Backlog Management, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Agile / Scrum, Stakeholder Management, Data Analysis
Technical: Python, SQL, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Git, MySQL, MongoDB

Education

University of Windsor **Sep 2022 – Apr 2024**

Master of Applied Computing *CGPA - 8.00*

Gujarat Technological University **Aug 2016 – Aug 2020**

B.E. in Computer Engineering *CGPA - 8.98*